



Sweet Android

Android versions are named after desserts, 1.5 is Cupcake. Donut, Eclair and Flan releases are scheduled this year

Pop Cap

One of the biggest games in the casual gaming market, it's all set to release a bunch of games for Android devices

It all started in October 2003 as Android Inc., co-founded by Andy Rubin, Rich Miner, Nick Sears and Chris White. All four of them went on to join Google. Before we heard of them, Google bought Android and added it to their list of services – Google was entering the wireless world. When Google considers buying you, either you're very good, or Google has heaps of cash to splurge. In the case of Android, we're still figuring which holds true. Based on the Linux kernel and released as an open source platform under the Apache licence, Android is attracting wide industry backing.

The Open Handset Alliance was born on November 5, 2007. Google, HTC, Motorola and Qualcomm, among others, forged a 34-member strong conglomerate. Nevertheless, Android faces a battle against industry heavy weights such as Symbian

and Windows Mobile who are certainly in no mood to take the threat lying down. In this age of cost and features, mechanical design, style and class are important criteria for today's borrow-and-spend customer. "What's inside doesn't really matter. Except for the geeks, but those are not mainstream customers," explains Eric Bustarret, an active mobile developer in France. With so much hype of surrounding Android, we got in touch with several personalities, including entrepreneurs, developers and critics associated with Android and the mobile platform.

Alexander Muse is the founder of Big in Japan, winner of Google's 2008 Android Developer Challenge and developer of ShopSavvy. According to Muse, "the first Android handset was released almost a year ago. Since its launch, millions of handsets have been sold in the North American and European markets. Besides, thousands of applications have been built for the Android platform."

In fact, this year, more than 12 carriers are launching 15 different handsets running Android. Muse fervently vouches for Android, "Imagine a free, open source

Symbian already has a market share of more than 70 per cent. Thinking it might be able to retain that market share is foolish. The iPhone and Android are already taking significant share. Can Symbian turn the momentum around? Sure, but it is unlikely

Android: Google again?

A closer look at Android and the Open Handset Alliance. Will it change the way we look at phones?

Nash David

nash.david@thinkdigit.com



Chaitanya Surpur

